Spiraea thunbergii 'Ogon'

Ogon Spirea, Mellow Yellow Spirea, Golden Thunberg Spirea

Family: Rosaceae

Fountain Garden: 24 | Overlook: 3 | Rockery: 4 | Wonderland: 6 | Piedmont: 60 | **TOTAL 97**



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–5 ft (0.9–1.5 m) high × 3–5 ft (0.9–1.5 m) wide.
Dense twiggy with arching branches

Sun

Water

Soil
Average, moist but well-drained soils. Tolerates a range of soils

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 4–8. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Early spring white flowers before leaves. Golden-yellow new foliage that matures to green and turns orange in fall. Heat and humidity tolerant with adequate moisture. Attractive three-season interest. Note: parent species can be invasive in some areas

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Cultivar of Spiraea thunbergii, native to China and Japan. 'Ogon' means "gold" in Japanese. Discovered in a Tokyo plant market by Barry Yinger and introduced to the US in 1993. Trade name Mellow Yellow. More popular than the green-leaved species

Form
Dense twiggy deciduous shrub with arching branches. Narrow willow-like leaves emerge golden yellow in spring, mature to bright green in summer, and turn orange in fall. Tiny white flowers in early spring before foliage. Fine texture. Attracts pollinators. Golden-leaved Thunberg spirea. Early white flowers followed by golden spring foliage that turns orange in fall. Fine willow-like texture. Excellent for Atlanta.
Heat tolerant. Introduced from Japan in 1993

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun for best golden foliage. Excellent for borders, foundations, and mass plantings. Prune after flowering to maintain shape. Low maintenance. Water to establish. Outstanding early spring and foliage color plant

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest- and disease-free. Heat and humidity tolerant with moisture. Attracts pollinators. Deer and rabbit resistant. Occasional leaf spots or mildew possible. No serious problems stated as dominant. Parent species can be invasive in some regions

Symptoms

None stated